Gmail

Aryan Thanki <athanki5670@gmail.com>

Question on the academic entry requirements for Visual Effects
6 messages

Aryan T <athanki5670@gmail.com> 24 August 2024 at 12:27
To: "m.p.bowman@herts.ac.uk" <m.p.bowman@herts.ac.uk>

Hello

I am wondering what level of proficiency in Maths and Physics I would be expected to be able to demonstrate on the Visual Effects degree programme at Herts (given your entry requirements of B-C's at A Level) and Maths and Physics a level not required

Would I need to be able to demonstrate the same level of ability in these above mentioned subjects as an A* A Level student?

E.g would I need to have the same level of mathematical ability as an A* A Level Maths student

You don't ask for an A* in either Maths or Physics in your entry requirements

Regards

Aryan

Martin Bowman <m.p.bowman@herts.ac.uk> 11 September 2024 at 17:00
To: Aryan T <athanki5670@gmail.com>

Hello Aryan

Sorry for the slow reply I've just got back from annual leave. Regarding application to 3D Animation and VFX at Hertfordshire, there is no A level requirement for maths and physics. We look for art based qualifications (Fine Art A level etc). We expect a GCSE in maths (grade 4 / C or higher) but nothing in physics. That said, knowledge of maths and physics is useful to anyone wanting to do complex work in VFX (for simulations / particles/ fluids etc) as many of those skills will require an ability to work with code and algorithms, and those subjects are usually good for helping students develop that part of their minds.

I hope that helps – you will be judged on your artistic skills (both digital and traditional) so make sure your portfolio is as amazing as possible. If you want some advice on what to show us, please watch this video that shows the type of work and the quality level we want:

https://vimeo.com/841286222

Regards

Martin

Martin Bowman
Principal Lecturer & Admissions Tutor
Digital Animation
University of Hertfordshire
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https://vimeo.com/uhanimation

From: Aryan T <athanki5670@gmail.com>
Sent: Saturday, August 24, 2024 12:28 PM
To: Martin Bowman <m.p.bowman@herts.ac.uk>
Subject: Question on the academic entry requirements for Visual Effects

> You don't often get email from athanki5670@gmail.com. Learn why this is important

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Aryan T <athanki5670@gmail.com> 11 September 2024 at 17:18
To: Martin Bowman <m.p.bowman@herts.ac.uk>

Hi Martin

Thanks for your reply

So being knowledgeable about physical sciences (e.g physics and chemistry) and the life sciences (biology) is important for certain select areas within VFX and animation but not the entire industry?

My art is quite good but my science and maths is not.

I read an article online that was from India (where I am from), which said students working in animation and visual effects need to study anatomy for an entire year (equivalent to medical and dental school level) to do their job effectively. And study it to the same level as medical students (like doctors…)

Is this true? Based on your own experience.

In India, pass grades (in their equivalent of the A level) are generally required for animation/VFX- much the same as the requirements here- and I don't see evidence of the requirements in the article being a necessary stipulation.

In India, the students admitted for animation and visual effects aren't going to be necessarily as proficient as medical students in anatomy- due to the entry requirements- but they become animators and work in visual effects. Much like the situation here.

That isn't even a requirement for admission. You don't need to do science to get admission into animation and VFX, in India, either.

Just to give context, I got a 9 in GCSE Art (and an A* in the A level in Art) however I got a 6 in Biology, Chemistry and Physics and Maths (a 6 normally leads to D-E grades in sciences and maths at a level).

The 9/6 I refer to is concerning the 9-1 GCSE Grades I'm sure you're aware of.

So the article sort of baffled me.

Would be good to hear from you soon and have a great evening

Regards

Aryan
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Martin Bowman <m.p.bowman@herts.ac.uk> 12 September 2024 at 17:31
To: Aryan T <athanki5670@gmail.com>

Hello Aryan

"So being knowledgeable about physical sciences (e.g physics and chemistry) and the life sciences (biology) is important for certain select areas within VFX and animation but not the entire industry?"

No, not essential at all, as long as you don't mind learning about those things if you wish to work in specific areas in future. Most of my students don't have this knowledge when they arrive; if they decide they want to be a creature FX artist for example they have to learn about muscles/skin/fat layers as part of their research. If they want to be a good fluid FX artist they really need to look at how fluids moves for example, but none of these require expert levels of science knowledge. You'd only need that if you were going to become a programmer. It would be essential at that point.

"My art is quite good but my science and maths is not."

Science doesn't matter, but you will need to achieve a certain level in maths to get in – I don't know what that will be from India; our international admissions staff would have to talk to you about that. In the UK we require a GCSE or iGCSE in maths at grade 4 / C or higher – your grade of 6 is perfectly fine for us.

"I read an article online that was from India (where I am from), which said students working in animation and visual effects need to study anatomy for an entire year (equivalent to medical and dental school level) to do their job effectively. And study it to the same level as medical students (like doctors…)

Is this true? Based on your own experience."

Not in the UK, or anywhere I know of in Europe or the USA! I suspect the person writing the article doesn't know what they are talking about; unless this is a particularly local issue to India? Or possibly the author of the article is confusing programmers who work in Animation or VFX and who write new tools or software for artists to use? Those people would need advanced knowledge. Artists however need to be really good at art and be creative people (and also learn a lot of software, and it can be useful to have some basic programming skills).

If a student wants to be a character artist they would need to attend our life drawing classes and we would expect them to look at medical diagrams of muscles and learn about how they react with each other, but that would be their personal study – we don't have classes on this area. If a student doesn't want to be a character artist they would not need to learn these areas. We do make life drawing classes mandatory in the first year though to ensure all students have a minimum level of art skills.

Hope that helps

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Aryan T <athanki5670@gmail.com> 12 September 2024 at 19:19
To: Martin Bowman <m.p.bowman@herts.ac.uk>

Hello

Many thanks for your reply. Extremely helpful.

Just to clarify:

You said the following:

If a student wants to be a character artist they would need to attend our life drawing classes and we would expect them to look at medical diagrams of muscles and learn about how they react with each other, but that would be their personal study – we don't have classes on this area. If a student doesn't want to be a character artist they would not need to learn these areas. We do make life drawing classes mandatory in the first year though to ensure all students have a minimum level of art skills.

So I need to study anatomy to the same depth as medical students or just on a level that allows me to do my work as a character artist?

For reference, for Medical school admission in the UK:

Science A Levels are an absolute requirement

A* grades in A Level Biology (for the anatomy and physiology component of Medicine) are mandatory

I don't have anywhere near the A* grade at A Level in Biology (I haven't even done it) and I am looking at becoming a character artist.

Regards and many, many thanks for your advice

Aryan
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Martin Bowman <m.p.bowman@herts.ac.uk> 12 September 2024 at 23:13
To: Aryan T <athanki5670@gmail.com>

Hello Aryan

You just need to study enough to know where the muscles are in the body, what they look like and some understanding of how they work in relation to each other. The level you need to be an artist. You do not need to be a doctor! We are not a medical school, we are an art degree!

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